

**Board 1**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ A J 10 4  
 ♥ A 9  
 ♦ 9 8 7 5 3 2  
 ♣ 2

♠ 6  
 ♥ K Q 8 7 2  
 ♦ K Q  
 ♣ A K 9 6 3



♠ 9 8 5 3 2  
 ♥ 10 5 4 3  
 ♦ J 10  
 ♣ 5 4

♠ K Q 7  
 ♥ J 6  
 ♦ A 6 4  
 ♣ Q J 10 8 7

| <i>West</i>  | <i>North</i> | <i>East</i> | <i>South</i> |
|--------------|--------------|-------------|--------------|
|              | 1 ♥          | Pass        | 2 ♣          |
| Pass         | 4NT          | Pass        | 5 ♣          |
| All Pass     |              |             |              |
| 5 ♣ by South |              |             |              |
| Lead: ♥ A    |              |             |              |

This is the companion to Deal 6. The cards are the same except that the ♦s and ♣s have been swapped.

Again, NORTH has no problem as long as SOUTH holds at least one Key-card. When SOUTH responds 5 ♣, (showing one Key-card), NORTH can pass.

That's what happens here.

**Board 2**

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 4  
 ♥ 9 7 5 2  
 ♦ 9 5 4 3  
 ♣ 8 7 4 2

♠ K Q J 8 7 5 2

♥ 4

♦ K 6

♣ A K 5

|   |   |   |
|---|---|---|
|   | N |   |
| W |   | E |
|   | S |   |

♠ 10 3

♥ A K 8 6

♦ 10 8 7 2

♣ 10 6 3

♠ A 9 6

♥ Q J 10 3

♦ A Q J

♣ Q J 9

NORTH needs to know how many Aces SOUTH holds.

One way to find out would be to bid 3♠, (which is forcing), then launch Blackwood.

Another way is to bid 4♣ (Gerber) right now.

The first way is probably better but we needed a Gerber example.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             |       |      | 1NT   |
| Pass        | 4♣    | Pass | 4♠    |
| Pass        | 6♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♣4    |       |      |       |

**Board 3**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 9 6  
 ♥ 8 6 4 2  
 ♦ A 10 8 6 2  
 ♣ 10 3

♠ A J 10 5

♥ A K

♦ K 5

♣ A K Q J 4



♠ 2

♥ J 10 9 3

♦ Q J 9 7 4 3

♣ 8 5

♠ K Q 8 7 4 3

♥ Q 7 5

♦ —

♣ 9 7 6 2

SOUTH's positive response shows 8+ points and five or more cards headed by at least two honors.

NORTH figures a small slam would be safe, but just to be sure she uses Blackwood.

SOUTH's 6♦ reply shows one Key-card which must be the trump King, and a ♦ void!.

NORTH readjusts her thinking and decides to bid the Grand.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 2♣    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 6♦    |
| Pass        | 7♠    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 7♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦ A   |       |      |       |

**Board 4**

North Deals

Both Vul

♠ 10 9 5 4  
 ♥ 6 4  
 ♦ 5 2  
 ♣ J 10 5 4 2

♠ K Q 3

♥ K 10 9 3

♦ A 6

♣ K Q 9 6



♠ J 8 7 2

♥ J

♦ J 10 9 8 7 4

♣ A 3

♠ A 6

♥ A Q 8 7 5 2

♦ K Q 3

♣ 8 7

SOUTH jumps in ♥s, showing a good suit and slam interest.

NORTH has great ♥ support so bids RKCB 4NT.

SOUTH responds 5♠, showing two Key Cards and the ♥Q.

That is enough for NORTH to bid the slam.

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1NT   | Pass | 3♥    |
| Pass        | 4NT   | Pass | 5♠    |
| Pass        | 6♥    |      |       |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♥ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♦5    |       |      |       |

**Board 5**

North Deals

None Vul

♠ J 8  
 ♥ 10 6 5 3 2  
 ♦ Q 10 4  
 ♣ 10 8 7

♠ A Q 6 4

♥ A K Q

♦ A 5

♣ K J 6 3



♠ 9

♥ J 9 7 4

♦ J 9 7 3 2

♣ 9 5 2

♠ K 10 7 5 3 2

♥ 8

♦ K 8 6

♣ A Q 4

When NORTH agrees to ♠s, SOUTH will not stop short of a slam. The RKCB 4NT bid tells SOUTH that they have all five Key Cards since NORTH could hardly have a 2♣ opening hand with no Aces.

SOUTH's 5♥ bid is the Queen Ask, and NORTH's reply confirms that she holds the ♠Q, and also has the ♣K.

SOUTH figures the ♠ suit will run, and this should be enough for Grand Slam. He chooses 7NT.

| West         | North | East | South |
|--------------|-------|------|-------|
|              | 2♣    | Pass | 2♠    |
| Pass         | 3♠    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass         | 5♦    | Pass | 5♥    |
| Pass         | 6♣    | Pass | 7NT   |
| All Pass     |       |      |       |
| 7NT by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥6     |       |      |       |

**Board 6**

North Deals

E-W Vul

♠ J 2  
 ♥ A K 7 5 4  
 ♦ 10 8 4  
 ♣ 10 8 7

♠ Q 8 6

♥ Q J 3

♦ A J 5

♣ A J 6 5



♠ 10 9 4  
 ♥ 10 9 6 2  
 ♦ 9 6 3  
 ♣ 9 3 2

♠ A K 7 5 3

♥ 8

♦ K Q 7 2

♣ K Q 4

SOUTH knows there are enough points for slam, but she is worried about the trump suit. NORTH's support doesn't guarantee more than three ♠s, and if they are not headed by the Queen she could lose a trump trick.

Her RKCB bid relieves her mind when SOUTH claims two Key Cards PLUS the ♠Q. She bids 6♠ (and hopes for a 3-2 trump split!).

| West        | North | East | South |
|-------------|-------|------|-------|
|             | 1NT   | Pass | 3♠    |
| Pass        | 4♠    | Pass | 4NT   |
| Pass        | 5♠    | Pass | 6♠    |
| All Pass    |       |      |       |
| 6♠ by South |       |      |       |
| Lead: ♥K    |       |      |       |